

The GSAM Study Bible

Everything from your transcripts on One Goldman & the buy side · the firm decoded · what Goldman Sachs Asset Management is, what it wants to be known for, and every client story worth knowing

Raw material for a letter you write yourself · badges: **TRANSCRIPT** = your own events, quoted · **VERIFIED** = public record · **LIKELY** = credible secondary · **BEST GUESS** = labelled inference

How to use this document

You're writing the letter yourself, so this is deliberately **ammunition, not prose**. Part A is everything your own transcripts say that touches One Goldman, the buy side and client work, quoted so you can cite what you actually heard. Parts B and C are the firm and GSAM decoded. Part D is every major client story with the context behind it, so you understand *why* each one happened, not just that it did. The "why" you're looking for lives in the collisions between Part A (what you heard) and Part D (what the firm does when nobody's presenting to students).

PART A — What your transcripts actually say

A1. The One-Goldman idea, in the speakers' own words **TRANSCRIPT**

"A salesperson is the conductor of the orchestra... surrounded by experts — Jess's team in research, Mini's team in execution, colleagues across the road in commodities. My job is to pull it all together and play the music the client wants."

Jack (Head of UK Sales), equities panel — and his sharper point: he pitches "a conversation, not an idea"; the days of ringing a client with one idea and hearing "buy me \$10 million" are gone.

"Instead of multiple GS teams separately calling the same sovereign wealth fund, a centralised client group presents the whole alternatives shelf and helps allocators choose exposures, with strategy specialists behind it."

Ahmed (Partner, private credit), buy-side fireside — note: this sentence is literally a description of the client-solutions function you're applying to. Your own transcript defines the job.

Consolidation, per Ahmed: the merchant bank and special situations group used to be "separate, sometimes competing pockets." Under the current CEO: (1) consolidate — "stop having internal teams competing with each other and confusing the outside world"; (2) convert from balance-sheet investing to third-party capital, because "balance sheet is constrained and can be pulled at the worst time; client capital scales." Today the balance sheet is ~10% of what they invest and the platform "looks and feels like an external manager."

Ahmed — this is One Goldman applied to AWM's own architecture.

"How many resources exist — commodities desks, macro desks — the optionality to attack a question from many angles."

Sam (consumer staples analyst) on why she loves GS specifically, single-stock panel.

"Talk to people (like Goldman) who talk to all the clients and see all the flows."

Guillaume (European strategy), macro panel — the sell side's unique seat: the clearinghouse position that only an integrated firm occupies.

A2. Everything the buy-side session gave you on AWM **TRANSCRIPT**

- **The firm map:** GBM (IB, FICC, equities) ≈70% of revenues; AWM ≈30% but "arguably growing faster." AWM's three pieces: wealth management (UHNW, family offices), public asset management, and alternatives (PE, private credit, secondaries, infrastructure, growth).

- **The strategic logic, in Ahmed's words:** in GBM Goldman is already top-tier — "when you're number one, you grow with the market." In AWM the firm has "strong but not always #1 positions in markets that are structurally growing faster." Alternatives are taking share from traditional assets; he cited BlackRock buying a very large infrastructure fund "precisely because that's where growth is." Goldman's "stated ambition is to keep taking share — which is exactly why it's an interesting place to start a career."
- **Private credit:** roughly doubled in five years into a ~\$1.5tn+ asset class; borrowers pay a premium for speed, certainty, confidentiality, custom structures; the investors structurally increasing allocations are "sovereign wealth funds, pensions, insurers" — the exact clients CSG covers. The post-GFC migration of credit out of banks is "still only halfway."
- **Deal routing:** with the platform consolidated, opportunities are routed by their nature across a return spectrum from high single digits to ~15%+ IRR — matched to the right fund rather than teams fighting over them.
- **The India view:** cautious on China; "India is the standout" — entering via downside-protected credit structures first.

A3. The client-craft material (your relationship evidence base) TRANSCRIPT

- **Mini:** "fifty-way competition for every single trade"; the differentiator is trust and likeability; the craft is knowing "what makes clients look smart to their own bosses." Her best client relationship today started when she and the client were both juniors doing end-of-day bookings.
- **Jack:** client relationships spanning decades — weddings, one client godfather to his youngest child; he introduces future fund founders to prime brokerage "five or six years before launch." His meeting discipline: "what did they want to get from that meeting? How can we add value to what they do?"
- **Jessica:** research is "one of the most client-facing jobs in the bank"; ~35,000 client interactions a year in the region; trust is built on intellectual honesty; her personal brand was being the "focal point" who connects a client to whoever holds the answer — the connector role again.
- **Shash (prime client services):** reps are "your people on the inside — a reflection of you inside Goldman"; prime is intensely competitive and the fine line is "pricing, service quality, relationships and technology"; "the analyst you're chatting to at a networking event may be a COO or global head of ops in ten years."
- **Securities lending:** GS's edge is longevity plus relationships with the giant asset owners and agent lenders (BlackRock, State Street types) so it "gets the first call when supply frees up"; scarce-borrow allocation is "judgment, not algorithm," with long memories attached.
- **Digital assets session — remember this one:** tokenised money-market-fund collateral was framed as a way to avoid "the 2022 UK gilt/LDI-style fire-sale death spiral." Hold that thought: the LDI crisis is the backdrop to the BAE story in Part D.

PART B — The firm, decoded

B1. The divisions and the 2025 money VERIFIED



Firmwide FY2025: net revenues **\$58.3bn**, net earnings **\$17.2bn**. Inside GBM: Equities **\$16.5bn**, FICC **\$14.5bn**, Investment Banking fees **\$9.3bn** (advisory \$4.7bn, debt underwriting \$2.8bn, equity underwriting \$1.8bn). AWM is the remainder, roughly \$16–17bn

LIKELY — the remainder also includes the small Platform Solutions segment; check the 10-K if you want the exact split .

The texture difference (the insight that beats the numbers): GBM's fees are episodic — every deal and trade must be re-won. AWM's management fees recur for every day a mandate stays funded. That is why the smaller division is the

growth priority: recurring revenue is worth more per dollar, to shareholders and to strategy. Ahmed's 70/30 split from your transcript matches the reported numbers almost exactly — a nice credibility check on your own notes.

B2. How they interlink — the client's journey through the machine LIKELY

- **IB → PWM:** the founder whose company IB floats or sells suddenly has hundreds of millions; Private Wealth manages the proceeds.
- **PWM → IB:** the wealth client who owns a business wants to sell it; referred into banking.
- **GBM ↔ AWM:** the pension fund whose trades the markets desks execute may hand its portfolio to Asset Management (the OCIO stories in Part D are exactly this class of client); AM strategies use market access; research serves everyone.
- **Prime → everything:** Jack introduces future fund founders to prime brokerage years before launch; prime's clients are tomorrow's asset-management counterparties.
- **The limits:** information barriers are real and you heard two first-hand (research/banking chaperones; the secondaries wall). One Goldman is coordination bounded by compliance, not a single bloodstream.

PART C — Goldman Sachs Asset Management, decoded

C1. What it is VERIFIED

The "primary investment area within Goldman Sachs": investment and advisory services across **public markets, private markets/alternatives, and outsourced solutions**, for pensions, sovereign wealth funds, insurers, endowments, foundations, financial advisors and individuals. AWM supervises **over \$3 trillion** in client assets. Led globally by **Marc Nachmann** (global head of Asset & Wealth Management).

C2. What makes it stand out — the five genuine differentiators

Differentiator	The substance
1. Full-shelf breadth LIKELY	Very few managers are genuinely top-tier across public markets AND alternatives AND advisory/OCIO simultaneously. Most rivals are one thing: BlackRock = indexing/scale, Blackstone = alternatives. GSAM's pitch is the whole shelf, conducted — which is why "solutions" is in the team's name.
2. The OCIO franchise VERIFIED	The industry's most trusted taker of entire portfolios: \$480bn in OCIO assets globally (as of 31 Mar 2026) , #1 in the US, top-two globally. The wins in Part D are this franchise compounding.
3. Alternatives at scale VERIFIED	\$627bn in alternatives (Dec 2025); \$115bn raised in 2025 alone; record \$2.37bn of alternatives management fees in 2025 (+8%) . Plus the democratisation push: the May 2025 GeoWealth/iCapital tie-up putting public + private into one model portfolio for advisors.
4. The lift-out capability VERIFIED	A pattern no rival matches at this scale: when GSAM wins a mega-mandate, the client's own investment team often <i>joins Goldman</i> (BAE 2023, UPS 2024). Institutions don't hand over their people to a firm they merely like; that is trust expressed as headcount.
5. European + sustainability depth via NN IP VERIFIED	The 2022 €1.7bn acquisition brought 900 people, ~90% ESG-integrated assets, and made the Netherlands GSAM's "centre of excellence for sustainability in public markets," lifting European AUM past \$600bn.

C3. What they want to be known for — reading the firm's mind BEST GUESS, built on verified statements

- **"Durable."** The word that runs through every earnings call: growing recurring management fees so the firm's earnings are less hostage to trading cycles. Every mandate won and kept serves this.
- **The safe pair of hands.** The OCIO wins are marketed hard because they say: the world's most sophisticated institutions trust us with *everything* — assets, strategy, even their people.
- **Solutions, not products.** The shift Ahmed described (centralised client group, whole shelf, allocator's-eye view) is the firm repositioning from "fund seller" to "partner who designs the answer" — the posting's own phrase is

"dedicated partnerships."

- **Alternatives leadership.** Where the industry's growth and fees are; \$627bn and climbing, with private credit (Ahmed's business) the spearhead.
- **One Goldman delivered.** AWM is where the firm's whole-platform pitch becomes literal: markets execution, research, banking relationships and investing under one coverage conversation.

PART D — The client stories, with the why behind each

BAE Systems Pension Schemes — £23bn OCIO · September 2023 · the UK landmark

What happened **VERIFIED**: the trustees of BAE Systems' two UK defined-benefit schemes outsourced management of ~£23bn to GSAM — **the largest OCIO mandate ever awarded in the UK market** — and BAE's in-house investment management team transferred into GSAM, continuing to serve the schemes from inside Goldman. At the time this affirmed GSAM as the second-largest OCIO manager globally (£200bn+ OCIO assets then).

What Goldman specifically brought **VERIFIED (from the announcement)**: proven capabilities in **liability-driven investing (LDI), cashflow-driven investing (CDI), sustainable investing, external manager selection and private markets** — i.e. the full shelf, not one product.

The context that makes it meaningful **LIKELY**: after the September 2022 UK gilt/LDI crisis (which your own digital-assets session referenced as the "fire-sale death spiral"), UK pension schemes were simultaneously better-funded (higher rates) and freshly aware of how operationally demanding managing a DB scheme had become. The rational response for many: hand the whole problem to a manager with LDI scars, scale and private-markets access. BAE choosing Goldman was the market's biggest public vote on who that manager should be.

Why it matters for your letter: it is the London flagship; it is client-side craft (years of coverage, an RFP, finals, then an onboarding so complete a workforce moved); and it connects to something you personally heard discussed.

UPS — \$43.4bn OCIO · May 2024 · one of the largest ever

What happened **VERIFIED**: UPS appointed GSAM as OCIO for its US and Canadian DB plans (\$43.4bn as of 31 Mar 2024) — one of the largest corporate pension OCIO mandates in history. The UPS in-house investment team joined Goldman's Atlanta office. The win affirmed GSAM as the **largest OCIO manager in the US**, with \$325bn+ OCIO assets globally at the time.

The pattern to notice: same shape as BAE — whole portfolio, plus the people. Two continents, one repeatable model. That repeatability is itself the product.

Verizon + Lockheed Martin — \$70bn+ · July 2026 · announced LAST MONTH

What happened **VERIFIED**: announced 9 July 2026: GSAM appointed OCIO by both Verizon and Lockheed Martin — collectively over **\$70bn**: ~\$30bn of DB OCIO assets across the two, plus ~\$40bn of Verizon defined-contribution assets under advisement. GSAM's OCIO assets now stand at **\$480bn globally (as of 31 Mar 2026)**.

Why it matters for your letter: it is the freshest possible proof point — five weeks old as you apply. Two of America's biggest corporate names, in one announcement, extending exactly the franchise BAE and UPS built. Citing this shows you follow the business in real time, not from a careers page.

NN Investment Partners — €1.7bn acquisition · completed April 2022 · the European play

What happened **VERIFIED**: Goldman bought Dutch manager NN IP from NN Group: 900 employees joined GSAM; European AUM rose past \$600bn; the Netherlands became GSAM's "centre of excellence for sustainability in public markets" (~90% of NN IP's assets were ESG-integrated). It also came with a long-term partnership managing NN Group's insurance assets.

Why it matters: it shows how GSAM grows when it can't grind share organically — buy capability, keep the people, plug the shelf gap (European clients + sustainable investing). Inorganic One-Goldman.

The alternatives & private credit engine · ongoing · Ahmed's world

The numbers **VERIFIED**: \$627bn in alternatives (Dec 2025); \$115bn raised in 2025; record \$2.37bn alternatives management fees in 2025. **The strategy you heard first-hand** **TRANSCRIPT**: private credit doubled in five years to ~\$1.5tn industry-wide with the bank-to-fund migration "only halfway"; the allocators driving it (SWFs, pensions, insurers) are CSG's exact client list; and the firm rebuilt itself from balance-sheet investor to third-party manager because "client capital scales."

Also on the shelf **LIKELY**: a top-tier insurance asset management franchise (running general-account assets for insurers) and Petershill (stakes in alternative managers). Depth beyond what any student letter needs, but gold in interviews.

PART E — Forming your "why": where the collisions are

You're writing this yourself, so just the raw collisions — the places where what you heard, what the firm does, and what you've lived intersect. One of these, felt honestly, is a letter.

- **Ahmed described your job before you knew it existed.** The "centralised client group presenting the whole alternatives shelf" is the client-solutions function. You heard the role's reason-for-being from a partner months before reading the posting.
- **The lift-outs are onboarding stories.** BAE and UPS climax in the exact craft you practised at Pictet — making a client's transition so seamless that trust survives it. At Goldman's scale, the transition included the client's own staff.
- **The 70/30 revenue split you can verify from your own notes.** Ahmed said 70/30; the 10-K says \$41.5bn vs ~\$17bn. When your insight-day notes reconcile to the annual report, you're no longer quoting either — you understand the firm.
- **The LDI thread runs through your whole journey.** A 2022 crisis you heard referenced on the digital-assets panel is the backdrop to the biggest UK mandate in history, won on LDI/CDI capability. Crisis → client need → mandate → recurring fees: the entire business model in one causal chain.
- **Fifty-way competition vs the durable fee.** Mini fights fifty rivals for every trade; a retained mandate earns fees every day without a fight. Understanding why the firm prizes the second explains why CSG exists — and why the client seat there is a career, not a sales job.

Sources. Part A: your own insight-event transcript (names flagged there as best-interpretation — verify before quoting people by full name). FY2025 financials: GS full-year 2025 earnings release / SEC filings. BAE: GSAM press release (Sept 2023), Professional Pensions, Pensions Expert. UPS: GSAM press release (May 2024), AI-CIO, Markets Media. Verizon/Lockheed: GSAM press release (9 Jul 2026), CNBC, P&I, PLANADVISER (\$480bn OCIO AUS as of 31/3/26). NN IP: GS press release (Apr 2022), ESG Today, Funds Europe. Alternatives figures (\$627bn, \$115bn raised, \$2.37bn fees): 2025 reporting via Markets Media/Kavout; treat precise figures as at their stated dates. One Goldman Sachs: GS's published firm history. Everything moves — re-verify any number you plan to say out loud in an interview.